



No politics in Google

Google's new policy forbids employees from having 'raging debates' over politics. <https://dgit.in/sep19-78>



Tesla in Germany?

Tesla is reportedly looking at northwest Germany for a new European factory. <https://dgit.in/sep19-79>



Breaking BIOS

Agent001 is getting irritated with all the faulty BIOS that motherboards are shipping with these days

Agent001 | agent001@digit.in

O

ne of the things I have to do quite frequently is build systems and prep them for running benchmarks. Over the

years, the process has become quite simplified. Rather than manually installing all the apps one after the other, it's easier to simply make a bootable image with all the drivers and software slipstreamed into it. However, this only works if you have to use the same hardware over and over again. When it comes to playing around with motherboards you simply have to get down and dirty. This is not because you can't build an OS image for all motherboard brands but because the number of boards shipping with Day 0 issues have gone up over the years.

The blame lies with both the motherboard manufacturers as well as the processor companies who have been rapidly pushing out refreshes every couple of months. It's so closely packed together that the folks working on motherboard BIOS' don't have enough time to iron out all the kinks before sending it out to production. Sometimes, the processor manufacturers move the launch date without a moment's notice just to beat the competition to market. This messes with the motherboard manufacturing process. Take for example the MSI B450 Tomahawk BIOS issues. Every place from tech forums to reddit to MSI's own forums are flooded with customers rant-

ing about their issues with this particular board. Motherboard's shipping with faulty BIOS isn't a new problem but when you have an economically priced motherboard such as the B450 Tomahawk, then the volume of complaints are enormous. We don't recommend the board in our Killer Rigs section because of this fact.

And it's not just this one board. I recently had to work with a Threadripper system that was using an MSI X399 MEG Creation. It is an excellent board for the X399 platform except for one glaring issue - You will always get

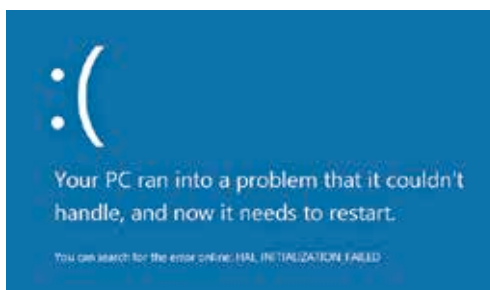
motherboard vendors that try to pack on more features.

Personally speaking, I haven't faced such issues with the simplest boards that are launched for each platform. And it's kind of obvious since the ones with the least number of features will have reduced points of failure. People simply need to vote with their wallet and check the forums before they purchase motherboards because the companies simply don't seem to care.

It's not all bad though. The UEFI BIOS are easier to navigate and we've seen fewer people goof-up with their

BIOS configurations now. Motherboard manufacturers have pre-built profiles which easily pick up the most compatible configuration and should anything go wrong, the board will reboot to a safe mode and allow you to fix things. This used to be a luxury about eight years ago but is now commonplace. However, using the prebuilt profiles

don't always give you the best possible performance. And enthusiasts want to tinker with the boards which is slowly turning out to be difficult. Instead of each vendor having a champion board, we now have come to a stage wherein each platform has that one good board whereas all the others are best avoided around launch time. Enough ranting now, I gotta go build another machine. I just hope that this board has no issues. 



a BSOD when installing Windows 10. The solution was to load the Intel Wi-Fi driver during the Windows 10 setup, only then could you rid yourself of the BSOD loop. This problem has existed since October 2018 and it would appear that Intel, Microsoft and MSI need to have a little chat to resolve the issue but even one whole year after the issue has surfaced, we're yet to see a solution. It's not just MSI, we see such issues with all